

Creative Team SOP Starter Kit

Ready-to-adapt standard operating procedures so your creative team runs consistently, even when you're not in the room.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Creative leads and studio owners running a team of more than one person, who are tired of quality and process depending on who happens to be handling a project that day.

HOW TO USE IT

Each SOP below is a starting template. Adapt the specifics to your team's actual tools and terminology, then treat it as the default way things are done — not a suggestion — unless someone has a good reason to deviate.

SOP 1 — NEW PROJECT INTAKE

Purpose: make sure no project starts without the information the team needs to do it right.

1. Client brief or discovery questionnaire completed and reviewed by the project lead.
2. Scope, budget, and timeline confirmed in writing before any design work begins.
3. Project added to the team tracker with a deadline and a named owner.
4. Kickoff note shared with everyone touching the project, summarizing the objective and constraints.

SOP 2 — DESIGN REVIEW

Purpose: catch quality and brand issues before work ever reaches the client.

1. Creator self-reviews against the original brief before submitting for review.
2. A second team member — not the creator — reviews for brand consistency and craft.
3. Feedback is given in writing and tied to the brief, not personal taste.
4. Creator revises and resubmits; the reviewer confirms before the client sees it.

SOP 3 — CLIENT REVISION HANDLING

Purpose: keep revisions organized and protect the project's scope.

1. All revision requests are logged in one place, even ones received by phone or voice note.
2. Each request is checked against the number of revision rounds actually agreed.
3. Anything beyond scope is flagged to the client before any work begins on it.
4. Each round of revisions is delivered as one complete update, not partial fixes trickling out.

SOP 4 — FILE HANDOFF & ARCHIVING

Purpose: make sure finished work stays usable and findable long after the project ends.

1. Files renamed and organized using the team's standard naming convention.
2. All formats required by the brief are delivered — source, print-ready, and web, as needed.
3. Final files archived in shared team storage, not left only on the creator's device.
4. Project marked complete in the tracker, with final files linked.

MAKE IT YOURS

Swap in your team's actual tool names — Trello, Notion, a shared drive, a WhatsApp group — wherever this kit says "tracker" or "shared storage." An SOP only works if it matches how your team actually communicates today, not an idealized version of it.

NEXT STEPS

These four SOPs cover the points where creative teams most often lose consistency: intake, review, revisions, and handoff. Add to this kit as you find your own team's repeated points of confusion — the pattern is always the same: write down what "good" looks like once, so it stops depending on memory.